

with money and sense of financial wellbeing has improved as she has allowed herself to let go a little. A much-needed reminder that, at its extreme, being ‘good with money’ – i.e. saving every penny and worrying over every purchase – does not necessarily equate to an easy or harmonious relationship with your finances. If you are not able to enjoy the money that you work so hard for, whether that enjoyment comes from spending, saving or a bit of both, then there may be something amiss, and tackling that could help you to squeeze a little bit more pleasure out of life, and fret a little bit less.

Perhaps unsurprisingly, much of the advice around spending anxiety that’s already out in the mainstream is aimed at people who have a pressing reason to be anxious about money – if it’s very tight, or there are debts to be settled etc. But, as with any type of anxiety, the threat doesn’t have to be real or true in order to have a huge hold over you, so when I was trying to work out how to navigate this new feeling of struggling to let go of money, I looked to general anxiety advice for guidance. Here are a few ways that you could start to soothe that analysis paralysis, and quieten the anxiety that follows a purchase:

- Write down your reasons for making the purchase. Seeing them in black and white can really help a decision to feel properly considered – even if the reason is just ‘I’ve wanted this for a while, and I can afford it’.
- Talk to someone that you trust. Often, hearing yourself explain the reasons why you feel anxious can help you to settle.